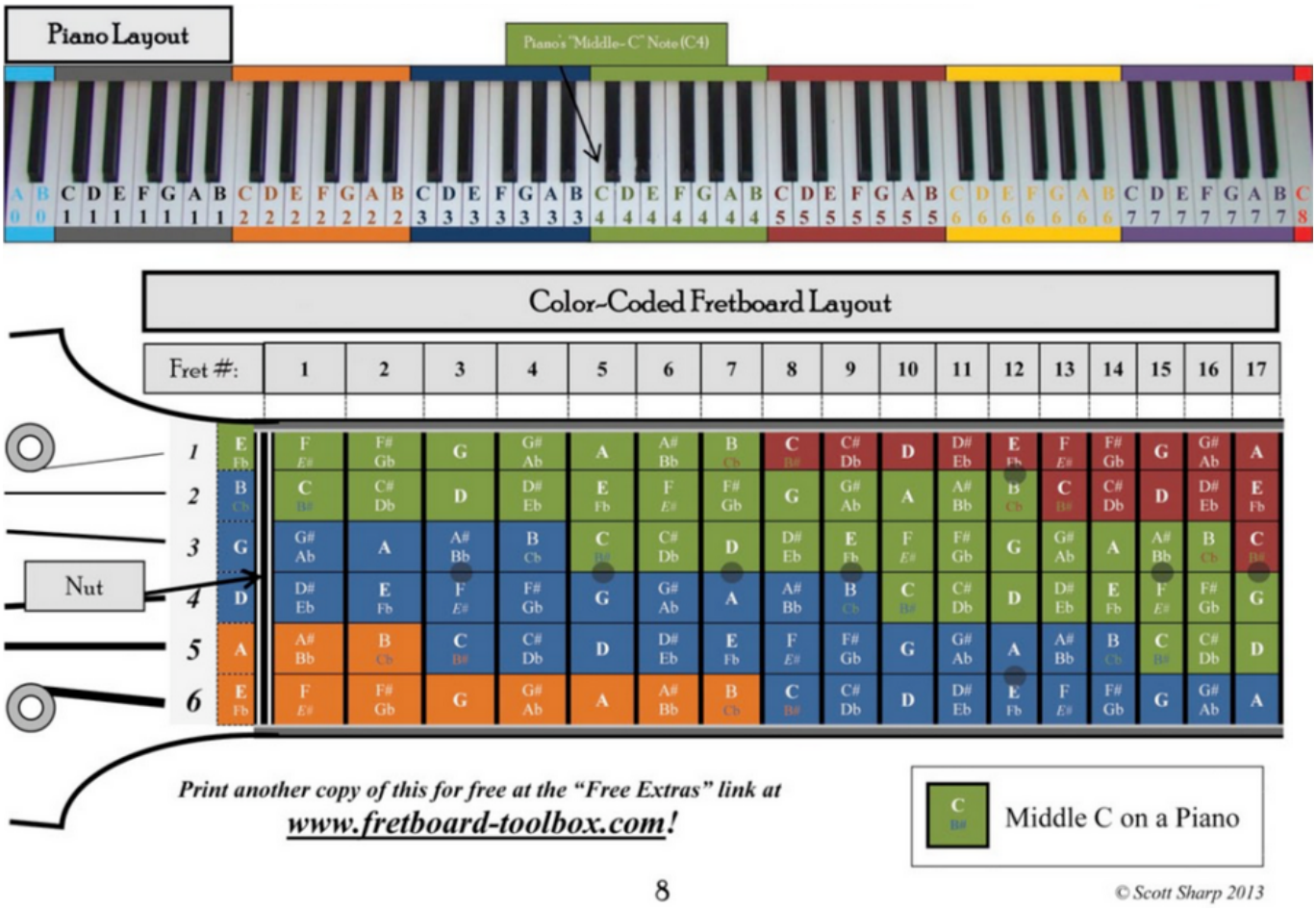
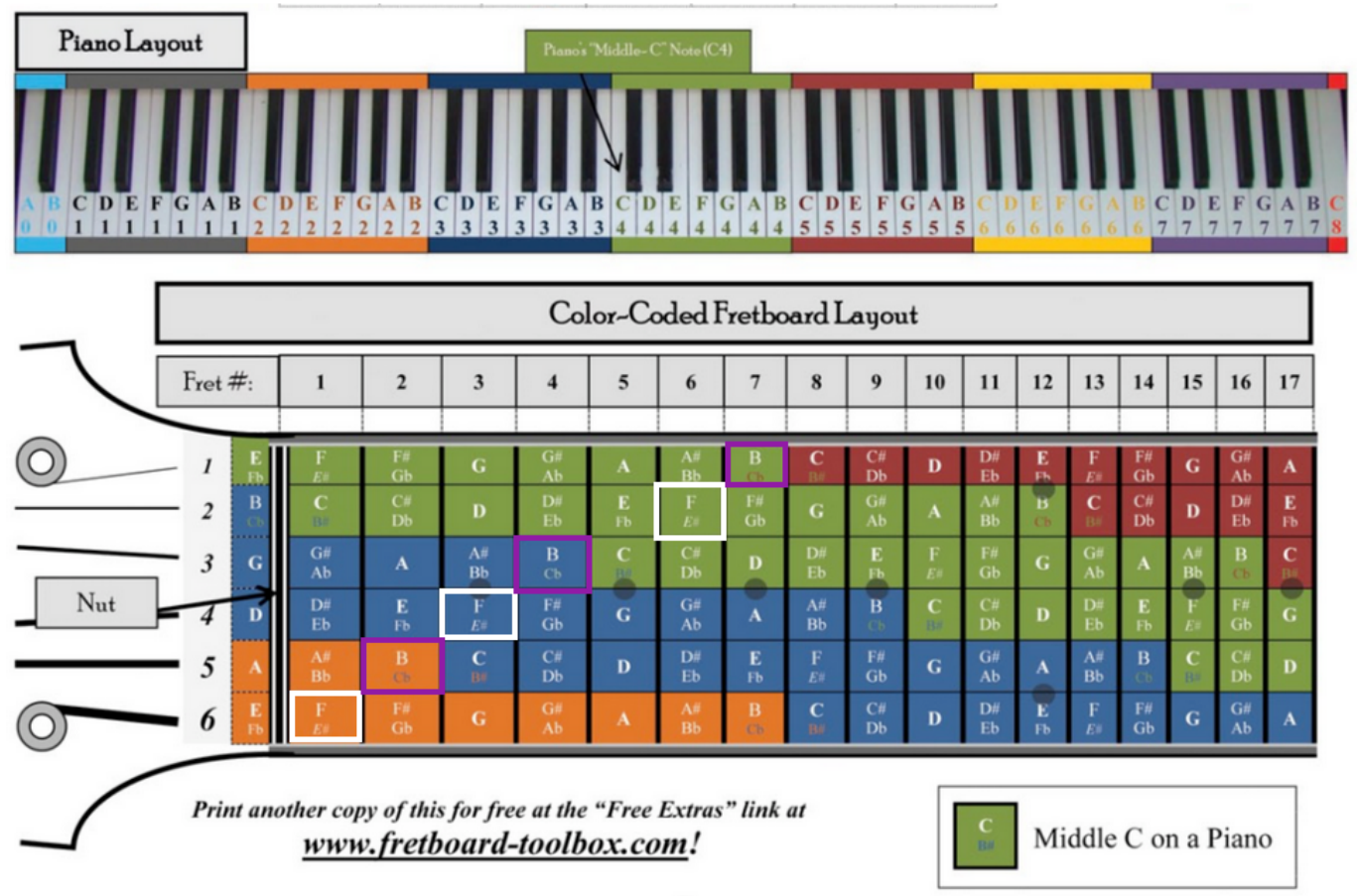
Links: https://appliedguitartheory.com/lessons/a-minor-pentatonic-scale/

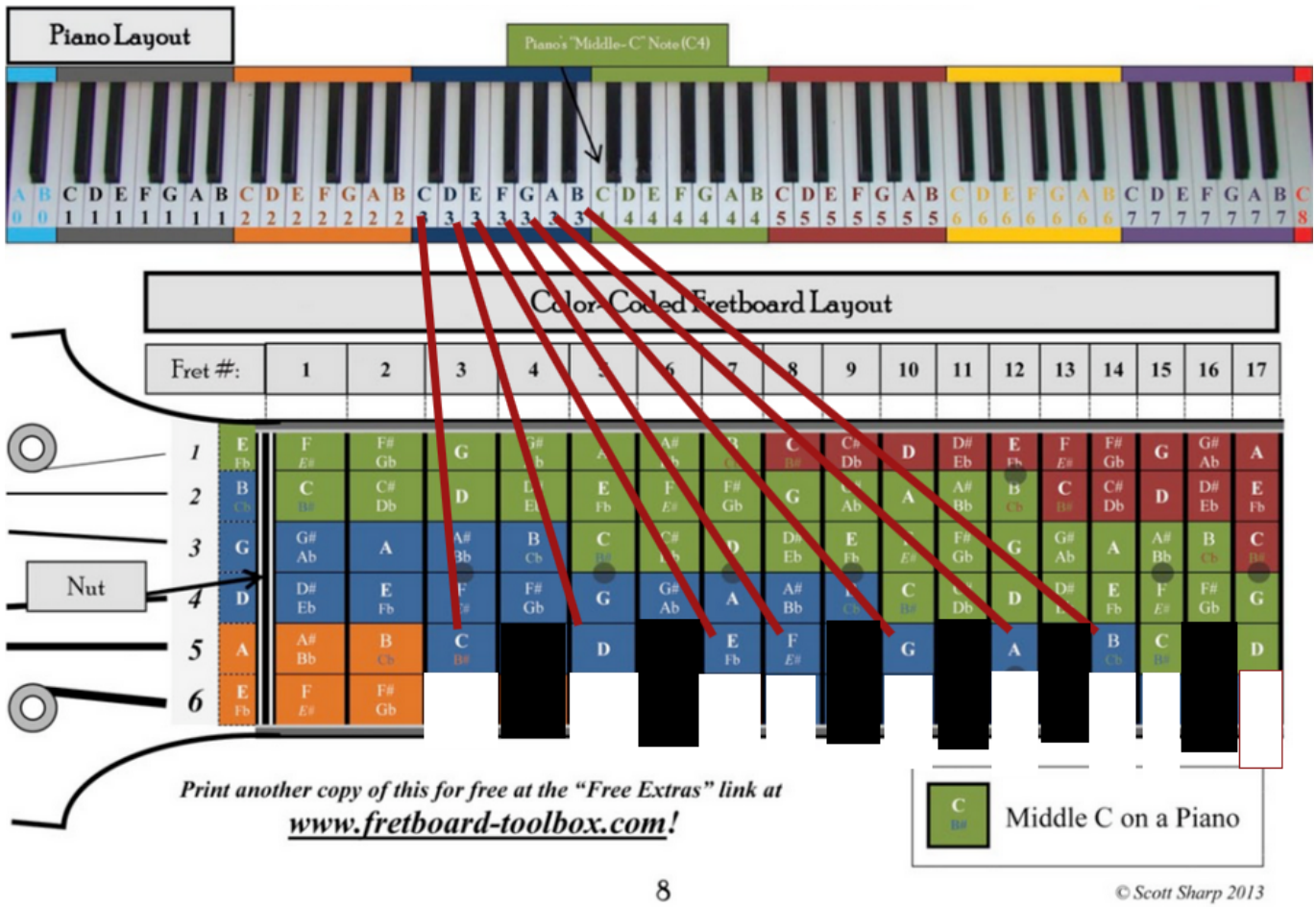
If we compare a piano keyobard to a guitar fretboard we have the following.



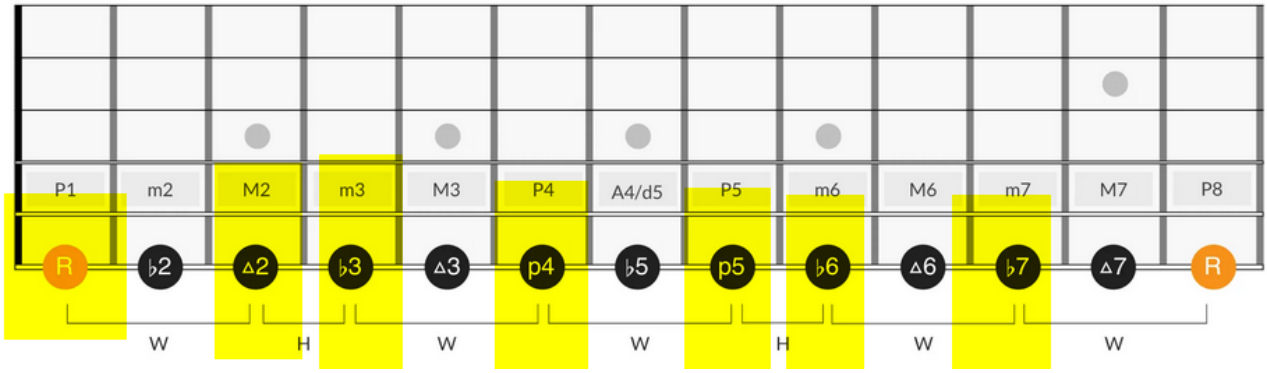
Notice the pattern for octaves.



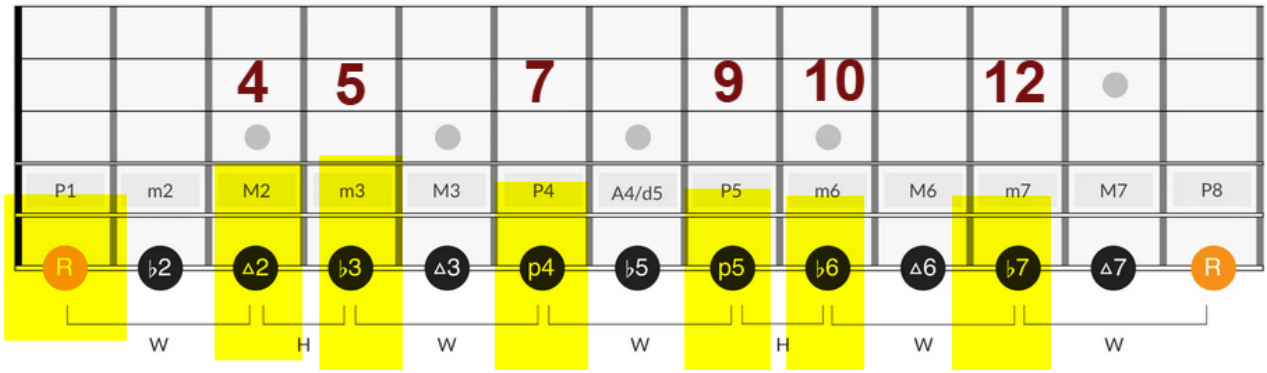
Playing C-major scale across a string



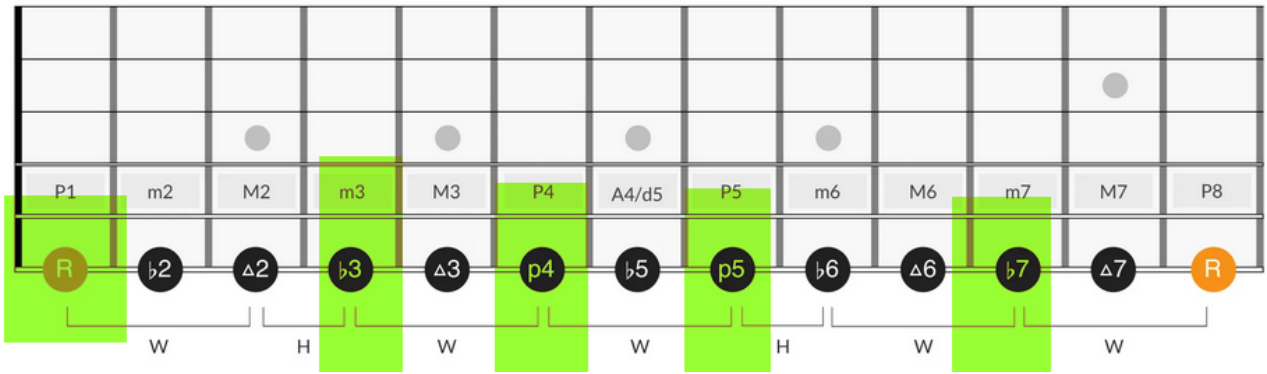
Minor scale.



Minor scale Back in Black.



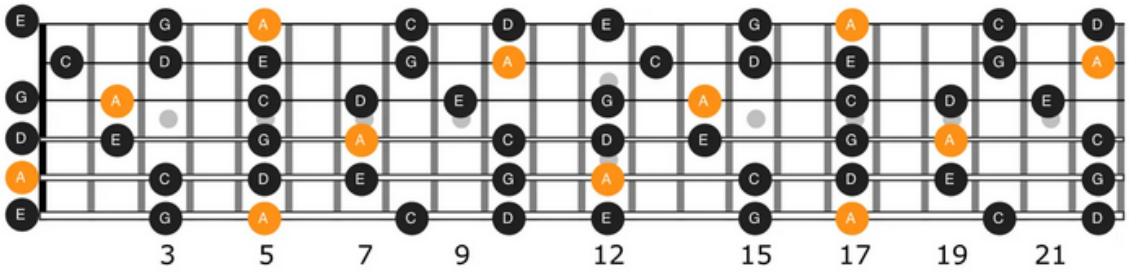
Minor pentatonic scale.



Minor pentatonic scale Fretboard.

5 positions of the A Minor Pentatonic Scale

The notes for the A minor pentatonic scale are found all over the fretboard, as shown in the diagram below.

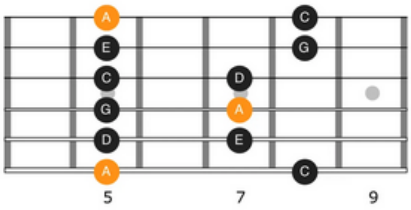


However, we can combine these notes into note groupings to form memorable scale patterns, or positions.

Minor pentatonic scale position 1.

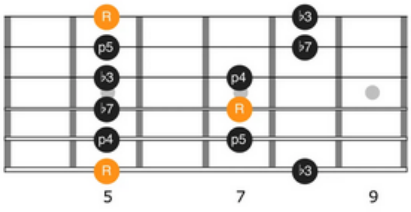
Scale Position 1

The first position of the A minor pentatonic starts with the A note on the 5th fret of the 6th string.

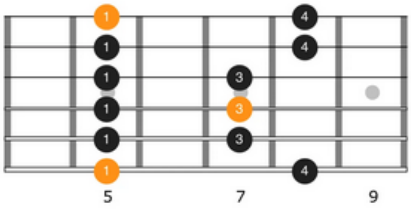


The first position contains three root notes, which form a triangular shape on the guitar fretboard:

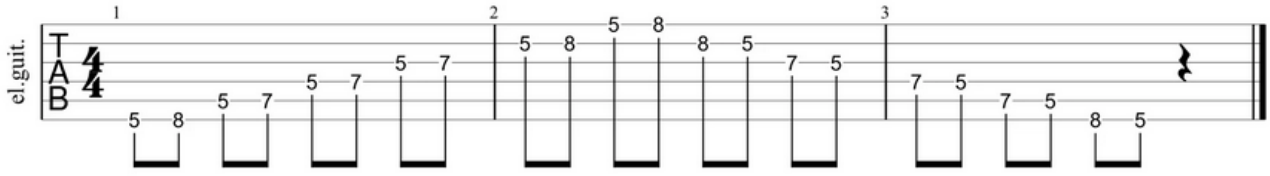
- 5th fret of string 6
- 7th fret of string 4
- 5th fret of string 1



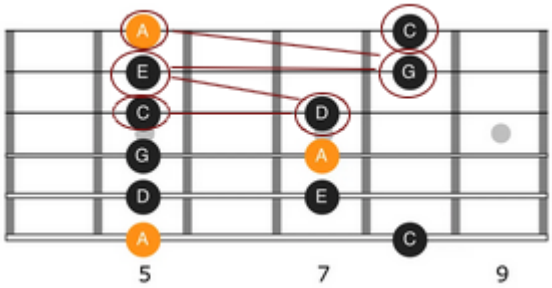
It's important to note that while this position can be played in both octaves of the fretboard (the same note pattern is found starting on the 15th fret of string 6), the interval locations are always the same relative to each other. In other words, with the root on the 6th string, I can always count over two string and up two frets to find another root note.



The bottom fretboard diagram outlines the suggested fingering for playing position 1 of the scale. When practicing the scale, it's a good idea to start and finish on a root note so you hear how the other intervals of the scale sound relative to the root.



Minor pentatonic scale position 1. No Woman No Cry


A
E
C
G
D
A
C
G
D
A
E
C
5
7
9